

THE STORY SO FAR

▶ As a result of this development, online gaming companies in India have laid off staff and are restructuring their businesses

▶ The number of online gamers grew to 507 million in the fiscal year 2021-22 from 450 million in the previous year, per eSports Players Welfare Association

▶ The outlook has become cloudy with the taxman's decision to impose 28 per cent goods and services tax (GST) on the deposit amount for online gaming

▶ Experts believe this may reduce the size of the industry by half as they expect more companies to shut down or domicile abroad in gaming-friendly nations

▶ Online games such as fantasy sports, poker, rummy, ludo, carrom, puzzles, etc., are more popular among the younger generation (16-25 years)

